

Practice Exercises on Justify the Conclusion Questions

1.

Kale has more nutritional value than spinach. But since collard greens have more nutritional value than lettuce, it follows that kale has more nutritional value than lettuce.

Any of the following, if introduced into the argument as an additional premise, makes the argument above logically correct EXCEPT:

- (A) Collard greens have more nutritional value than kale.
- (B) Spinach has more nutritional value than lettuce.
- (C) Spinach has more nutritional value than collard greens.
- (D) Spinach and collard greens have the same nutritional value.
- (E) Kale and collard greens have the same nutritional value.

2.

Although parapsychology is often considered a pseudoscience, it is in fact a genuine scientific enterprise, for it uses scientific methods such as controlled experiments and statistical tests of clearly stated hypotheses to examine the questions it raises.

The conclusion above is properly drawn if which of the following is assumed?

- (A) If a field of study can conclusively answer the questions it raises, then it is a genuine science.
- (B) Since parapsychology uses scientific methods, it will produce credible results.
- (C) Any enterprise that does not use controlled experiments and statistical tests is not genuine science.
- (D) Any field of study that employs scientific methods is a genuine scientific enterprise.
- (E) Since parapsychology raises clearly statable questions, they can be tested in controlled experiments.

3.

Even though most universities retain the royalties from faculty members' inventions, the faculty members retain the royalties from books and articles they write. Therefore, faculty members should retain the royalties from the educational computer software they develop.

The conclusion above would be more reasonably drawn if which of the following were inserted into the argument as an additional premise?

- (A) Royalties from inventions are higher than royalties from educational software programs.
- (B) Faculty members are more likely to produce educational software programs than inventions.
- (C) Inventions bring more prestige to universities than do books and articles.
- (D) In the experience of most universities, educational software programs are more marketable than are books and articles.
- (E) In terms of the criteria used to award royalties, educational software programs are more nearly comparable to books and articles than to inventions.

4.

Ann will either take a leave of absence from Technocomp and return in a year or else she will quit her job there; but she would not do either one unless she were offered a one-year teaching fellowship at a prestigious university. Technocomp will allow her to take a leave of absence if it does not find out that she has been offered the fellowship, but not otherwise. Therefore, Ann will quit her job at Technocomp only if Technocomp finds out she has been offered the fellowship.

Which one of the following, if assumed, allows the conclusion above to be properly drawn?

- (A) Technocomp will find out about Ann being offered the fellowship only if someone informs on her.
- (B) The reason Ann wants the fellowship is so she can quit her job at Technocomp.
- (C) Technocomp does not allow any of its employees to take a leave of absence in order to work for one of its competitors.
- (D) Ann will take a leave of absence if Technocomp allows her to take a leave of absence.
- (E) Ann would be offered the fellowship only if she quit her job at Technocomp.

5.

Some managers think that the best way to maximize employee performance is to institute stiff competition among employees. However, in situations where one competitor is perceived to be clearly superior, other competitors become anxious and doubt their own ability to perform. Thus, stiff competition can undermine the result it was intended to achieve.

The conclusion of the argument can be properly drawn if which one of the following is assumed?

- (A) Those who are perceived to be clearly superior almost always win.
- (B) The winner of a competition is often the competitor who exerts the most effort.
- (C) When competitors perceive the competition as winnable, their overall performance generally improves.
- (D) Doubting one's own ability to perform can decrease one's overall performance.
- (E) Competitors who work to undermine the confidence of other participants often do better in competitions.